

KNOW THE NAME. FOLLOW THE CODE.

Symbols, definitions & references. Three commands that connect them.

01 / SYMBOL

The named thing.

`greet`

Function, variable, class or parameter.

02 / DEFINITION

Where it is built.

`def greet(name):`

Introduces it or supplies its behavior.

03 / REFERENCE

Where it is used.

`greet("J.J.")`

A call, a read or another use.

ONE FUNCTION. ONE DEFINITION. TWO USES.

hello.py

01

def greet(name):

02

return "Hello, " + name

04

first = greet("J.J.")

05

second = greet("Sam")

DEFINITION

REFERENCE 1

REFERENCE 2

A reference points back to the same symbol, even on a different line or in another file.

- 01

Go to Definition

Where is this built?

Place the cursor on a use. Jump to the code that defines it.

USE > DEFINITION

F12

Mac / Windows / Linux
- 02

Find References

Where is this used?

Locate the uses your language service can resolve.

SYMBOL > USES

Shift + F12

Mac / Windows / Linux
- 03

Rename Symbol

Change the name everywhere it belongs.

Type a new name. Review the affected uses, then apply.

NAME > NEW NAME

F2

Mac / Windows / Linux

ALSO KEEP WITHIN REACH

Go to Symbol in File

Mac: `Cmd + Shift + 0`

Windows / Linux: `Ctrl + Shift + 0`

Command Palette

F1 on all three platforms

Search for the command by name.

Same spelling does not always mean the same symbol.
Scope matters. Rename follows code relationships; a text search only matches characters.

VS Code defaults. Keymaps and language support vary; some keyboards need Fn for F-keys.